BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #30 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

“I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives.”

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Where it often comes from

Parents with inherited conditions often carry deep guilt about the possibility of passing them on. Some avoid having children, and some blame themselves for a child’s struggles.

What Scripture teaches

“Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward.” “From everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children’s children.” A child’s life is in God’s hands, not only in genetics. Many children of parents with conditions are loved, helped, and flourish, and you can model faith and resilience. Guilt is not required of you. Love, honesty, and good care are.

> *“Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward”* (Psalm 127:3).

Also see

> “But from everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children’s children” (Psalm 103:17).

> “Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it” (Proverbs 22:6).

> “The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him” (Ezekiel 18:20).

> “‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.’” (Isaiah 49:15–16).

Common self-statements

- It is my fault if they struggle.
- I should not have had children.
- I have doomed them.
- They will suffer because of me.
- I cannot forgive myself.
- I am a bad parent.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either a perfect parent or a harmful one.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my children will suffer.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I harmed them.
- Personalization: Calling myself a ruiner.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I fear for my children?
- What strengths and love am I also passing on?
- What help and treatment would my children have available?
- Have I shared honestly with them at the right level?
- What does Scripture say about children and God's care?
- Whom can I talk to about my guilt?

Truth summary

> My children are God's heritage and in His care. I pass on love, faith, and resilience as well as genes. I can seek good care for them and release guilt that is not mine to carry.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Parenting
- Guilt/Shame
- Fear
- Trust
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly do I fear for my children?
- ☐ What strengths and love am I also passing on?
- ☐ What help and treatment would my children have available?
- ☐ Have I shared honestly with them at the right level?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about children and God's care?
- ☐ Whom can I talk to about my guilt?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Children are a heritage from the LORD.
- ☐ God's love reaches their children's children.
- ☐ I pass on love and faith too.
- ☐ Guilt is not mine to carry.
- ☐ God cares for my children.
- ☐ I can seek good help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 127:3**
  "Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward."
- ☐ **Psalm 103:17**
  "But from everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children's children."
- ☐ **Proverbs 22:6**
  "Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Love passed on: Each week, note one way you showed love or faith to your child.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 127:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My children are a heritage from the Lord.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Parenting" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what you give. Write the strengths you pass on.
- [ ] Be honest. Talk with your children in age-appropriate ways.
- [ ] Seek help early. Work with doctors and counselors.
- [ ] Pray for your children. Entrust them to God daily.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Love passed on
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear for my children. Forgive my guilt, hold them in Your care, and help me pass on love and faith. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.